

ROLEPLAYER CARD NO. 2

MEDICINE

SETTING

General Practice

PATIENT

You are an 18-year-old basketball player. You had a sudden severe pain at the front of your left knee during practice. An ice pack was applied and you were driven to the surgery by the team coach. Your knee is swelling and becoming very painful especially if you try to walk or put your weight on it. You have been experiencing pain in your knee for the last few days especially when you run or play sport. You don't remember injuring yourself, though your knee has been making a clicking/popping sound and sometimes locks. You want to play on the weekend.

TASK

- Explain your current symptoms. Explain that you think the problem is just 'growing pains'.
- Ask the doctor to fix your knee so that you will be able to play in the competition.
- Ask for a spray to numb the pain and for painkillers.
- Try to convince the doctor that you will recover quickly because you are young and fit.
- Be insistent as you want to play on the weekend, but eventually agree to follow the doctor's advice.

CANDIDATE CARD NO. 2

MEDICINE

SETTING

General Practice

DOCTOR

You have just examined the patient, an 18-year-old basketball player who has been brought to your surgery today by the team coach because of severe left knee pain. You diagnose a meniscus tear (torn cartilage).

TASK

- Take a brief history from the patient.
- Explain the likely diagnosis of a meniscus tear in a way that he/she will understand.
- Discuss immediate treatment (e.g., RICE regime – Rest, Ice, Compress, Elevation and Referral to physiotherapist).
- Explain why pain medication is not effective on its own.
- Explain why you are referring the patient to a physiotherapist (e.g., appropriate exercise plan, recovery strategy, specific treatments, etc.).
- Advise why he/she must not play sport until the pain has resolved and explain what the consequences of ignoring this advice could be.